Impediments Board

Make what's holding the team back visible, give each impediment an owner, and escalate it on time.

Manage Flow · Team Impediments · Escalation Ladder · Show the Cost

WORKED EXAMPLE · FICTIONAL TEAM

LEGEND

- Pink Sticky = Impediment
- Green Sticky = Resolution

1 Impediments

EACH STICKY: WHAT · WHAT IT COSTS US · OWNER · DATE RAISED

New

Raised, not yet picked up

- Thursday meeting overload · about 3 h a week each · Tom · 6 May

Being worked

Owner and next step agreed

- Test data isn't realistic · bugs found late · Alex · 10 Apr
- Reviews wait · 2 days an item · Sam · 29 Apr

Escalated

Needs help from outside the team

- Payments sign-off on every release · 2–3 days each · Head of Digital · 3 Apr
- Stock API late · substitutes stalled · Head of Warehouse · 22 Apr

Resolved

Add a green sticky: what fixed it

- No staging access for new joiners
- Platform added team access
- Deploy queue
- Self-service deploys

2 Escalation Ladder

MOVE UP IF NOT RESOLVED IN TIME

4 · LEADERSHIP
Changes policy or structure
Who: the portfolio group — Decision by 3 June

3 · MANAGEMENT
Decides or funds the fix
Who: Head of Digital — Escalate after 10 days

2 · SCRUM MASTER / COACH
Removes or chases it
Who: Tom — Escalate after 5 days

1 · TEAM
The team tries first
Who: the team, at the daily sync — Escalate after 2 days

3 Resolved Log

SHOW THE VALUE OF REMOVING IMPEDIMENTS

IMPEDIMENT	WHAT IT COST US	RESOLVED BY	DAYS OPEN	LESSON
No staging access	2 days per new joiner	Platform	6	ask Platform first
Deploy queue	a day per release	Checkout, Platform	21	automate it
Unclear criteria	rework	Example Mapping	14	map it first

"What's slowing us down that we've stopped noticing?"

"Who could remove this, and do they know it's costing us?"

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